

Hyperautomation Fundamentals

When RPA, AI and process mining are combined the right way, you go from 'automating tasks' to 'rewriting how work happens'. Today you'll learn the stack, the order, the ROI math, and the tools — taught through a real ₹247-crore Indian banking case.

L6

WHAT'S INSIDE

- 01** Three horsemen: RPA · AI · Mining
- 02** The stack order that delivers ROI
- 03** Spotting automation candidates
- 04** The 5-factor ROI model
- 05** Enterprise tools at a glance

WHY HYPERAUTOMATION

₹247 crore in twelve months — one Indian bank's automation story

INVOICES PER YEAR

84 lakh

A Tier-1 Indian bank's annual supplier-invoice volume.

OLD COST PER TOUCH

₹162

Each invoice was touched by 2.3 humans — at ₹162 per touch.

NEW COST PER TOUCH

₹18

After RPA + AI + mining were stacked in the right order.

ANNUAL SAVING

₹247 Cr

Payback in 11 months. The stack behind it is what we study today.

LEARNING OUTCOMES

By the end of this lesson, you will be able to —

1

Define RPA, AI and process mining — and how they fit together.

2

Pick the optimal stack order for a smart automation programme.

3

Identify automation candidates from real back-office workloads.

4

Apply the 5-factor ROI model to prioritise opportunities.

5

Compare leading enterprise automation tools at a glance.

6

Build a 90-day pitch that wins funding for a smart automation pilot.

AGENDA

What we'll cover today

Short, sequenced parts. Each one builds on the last.

01

The three horsemen

RPA, AI and process mining — each one's strength, weakness, and natural place in the stack.

02

Stack order matters

Mine first. Automate next. Add intelligence last. Reverse it and the programme stalls.

03

5-factor ROI

Volume × handle-time × error rate × strategic fit ÷ build cost. The math behind 'fund this'.

04

Tools & pitch

UiPath, Automation Anywhere, Power Automate — and the one-page pitch that gets the cheque.

01

PART 1 OF 4

The three horsemen of smart automation

Each one is powerful alone. Combined, they let work happen at machine scale.

THE THREE TECHNOLOGIES

What each one does — and what each one cannot do

Naming each correctly is half the battle in any meeting. Confuse RPA with AI in front of an exec, and you lose the room.

R

RPA

Robotic Process Automation

Software bots that click, type and copy across screens — exactly as a human would. Best for high-volume, rule-based, fully digital steps.

A

AI

Artificial Intelligence

Cognition layer — handles the fuzzy stuff. Reads handwritten forms, classifies emails, extracts entities. Steps the bot can't do alone.

M

PROCESS MINING

Process Mining

Reads system logs and reconstructs how work *actually* flows — not how the SOP says. Surfaces hidden loops, rework and exceptions.

STACK ORDER

Mine first. Automate next. Add intelligence last.

Most failed automation programmes get the order wrong. They start with RPA on whatever a stakeholder volunteered, and discover six months later that the bot is automating exceptions, not the rule.

The right order:

- Mine — reveal what's **actually** happening.
- Automate — RPA the stable, rule-based steps.
- Augment — bring AI to the few steps where humans were guessing.

WHY IT WORKS

- Mining shows you the loops nobody mentioned — fix them first.
- RPA on stable steps yields predictable, fast ROI.
- AI is reserved for ambiguity — where it earns its keep.
- Reversing the order means automating chaos, then realising.
- The case studies that work all share this sequence.

02

PART 2 OF 4

Spotting candidates worth automating

The right candidate is not the loudest one. It's the one that scores well on five quiet factors.

CANDIDATE CRITERIA

Six criteria that decide whether a process is worth automating

Score each criterion 1–5. A candidate that averages above 3.5 is fundable. Below 3, walk away.



VOLUME

High volume

More cases per year = more savings. < 1,000 cases/yr is rarely worth it.



RULES

Rule-based

Decisions you can list as if/then. If a human says 'it depends', it's not RPA-ready yet.



DIGITAL

Fully digital

Inputs and outputs are screens, files, emails. Paper and phone calls fail step one.



STABLE

Stable steps

The process hasn't changed in months. Bots break when interfaces or rules shift weekly.



ERROR COSTLY

Error rate matters

The pain of a wrong outcome is high — re-work, customer harm, regulator letter.



TIME-CONSUMING

Time-consuming

Each case takes minutes, not seconds. Sub-30-second tasks rarely repay the build.

✦ THINK • PAIR •
SHARE

ACTIVITY

Sort six processes — RPA, AI-needed, or 'don't automate'

PROMPT

Decide for each of these. Justify each placement in one line.

1. *Copying GST invoice numbers from PDFs into SAP*
2. *Reading hand-written customer complaint forms*
3. *Approving leave requests under 3 days*
4. *Drafting a personal apology letter to a VIP customer*
5. *Reconciling 4 lakh bank transactions every night*
6. *Designing the next quarter's marketing campaign*

HOW TO RUN IT

- 1 60s solo — sort each into RPA / AI-needed / don't automate.
- 2 60s with a partner — debate the borderline cases.
- 3 60s share-out — instructor calls on a team.
- 4 30s reveal — instructor reveals canonical sort.

03

PART 3 OF 4

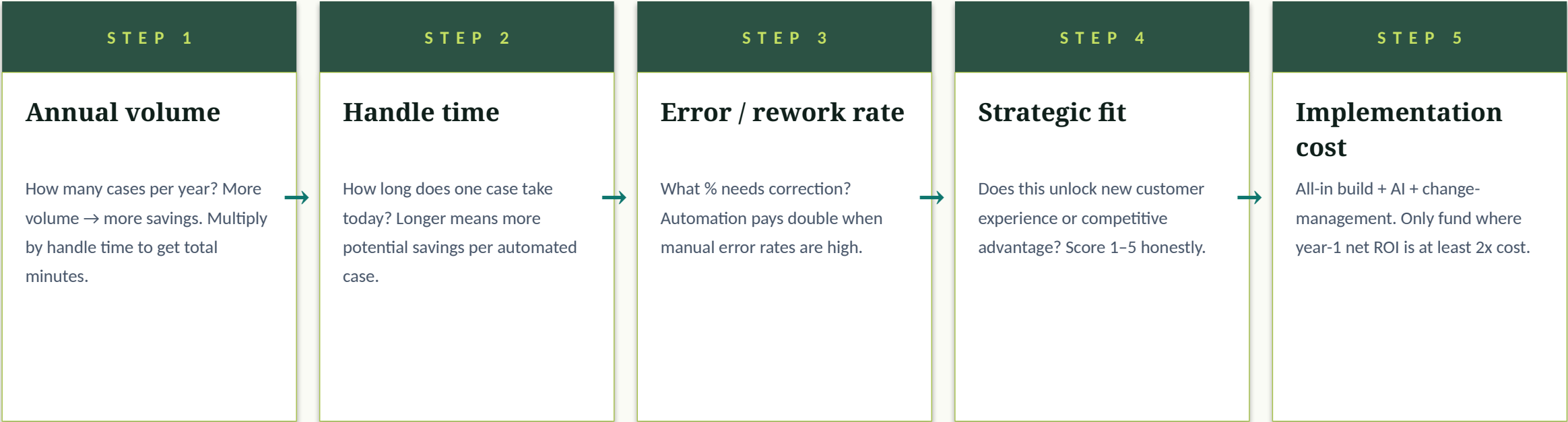
The 5-factor ROI model

The math your executive sponsor wants to see — and the only way to compare candidates fairly.

HOW TO RUN IT

Five factors. Multiplied together. The candidate with the highest score wins funding.

Apply the same model to every candidate. Standardised math beats individual storytelling — every time.



ENTERPRISE TOOLS

The big four — at a glance

The right tool is the one that fits your stack, your budget and your local talent pool. Nothing else.

Tool	Strongest at	Best fit	Watch out for
UiPath	Mature ecosystem	Large enterprises, GCC India	Premium pricing, learning curve
Automation Anywhere	Cloud-native bots	Cloud-first BFSI / IT firms	Smaller community than UiPath
Power Automate	Microsoft 365 fit	Mid-market on the MS stack	Limited for non-MS workloads
Blue Prism	Governance & control	Highly-regulated banks	Steeper UI for citizen devs

04

PART 4 OF 4

From analysis to a fundable pitch

Every great smart automation programme starts with a one-page pitch your sponsor cannot say no to.

WORKED EXAMPLE

Same Tier-1 bank — how the ₹247-crore pitch was built

THE SCENARIO

84 lakh supplier invoices a year, ₹312 crore handling cost, 23-day average payment cycle, regular audit findings about duplicate payments. The team had four candidate processes. Three were popular with managers; one was popular with the data.

THE TAKEAWAY

The data candidate won. Mining first showed 41% of touches were exception-handling on the same five vendors. RPA covered the stable 90%; AI handled the duplicates. Stack order, exactly as taught. ₹247 crore saved. Payback: 11 months.

WHAT TO NOTICE

- 1 Mining was done before any bot was scoped.
- 2 Five vendors caused 41% of exceptions — fixable upstream.
- 3 RPA covered the stable 90% of cases first; AI joined later.
- 4 ROI math followed the 5-factor model — sponsor signed in one meeting.

What is the right order to stack the three technologies?

A

AI → RPA → Mining (start with the cleverest tech)

B

Mining → RPA → AI

C

RPA → AI → Mining (deploy bots first, then learn)

D

Order does not matter as long as all three are deployed

What is the right order to stack the three technologies?



CORRECT ANSWER

Mining → RPA → AI

WHY

Mining first — to see what is actually happening. RPA next — to automate the stable, rule-based steps that mining surfaced. AI last — to handle the few steps where humans were judging. Reversing this order is the most common reason programmes stall.

Which process is the ***least*** suitable RPA candidate?

A

Reconciling 4 lakh bank transactions nightly using clear rules

B

Copying invoice numbers from PDFs into ERP — fully digital, stable

C

Approving leave requests under 3 days using HR rules

D

Designing the next marketing campaign for Diwali

*Which process is the ***least*** suitable RPA candidate?*



CORRECT ANSWER

Designing the next marketing campaign for Diwali

WHY

Marketing design is creative, ambiguous and changes constantly — every signal a bot needs is missing. The other three score high on volume, rule-clarity, digital input and stability. RPA does not replace judgement; it replaces clicks.

A candidate scores: 200,000 cases/yr, 12 min/case, 8% error rate, strategic fit 4/5, implementation cost ₹40 lakh. Year-1 net saving estimated ₹2.1 crore. Should you fund it?

A

No — strategic fit is below 5

B

No — error rate is too low

C

Yes — Year-1 net ROI exceeds 2× implementation cost

D

Yes — every project should be funded

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CORRECT ANSWER

Yes — Year-1 net ROI exceeds 2× implementation cost

WHY

₹2.1 crore saving against ₹40 lakh build is a 5.25× return in year one — comfortably above the 2× rule of thumb. Volume, handle-time and error-rate all multiply favourably. This is exactly the kind of candidate the 5-factor model is built to surface.

REFLECT & APPLY

Three questions before you close this lesson

Spend 60 seconds on each. Write the answers down — no scrolling, no shortcuts.

Q1

Identify one process around you (work, college, family) that is high-volume and rule-based. What's the volume?

Q2

If you applied the 5-factor model to that process today, where would the score break down — volume, rules, digital, stable, or strategic?

Q3

Which technology would you reach for first — mining, RPA or AI? Be honest about why.

Pitch a smart automation pilot — one page, real company

Pick a real Indian company you know. Identify one back-office process worth automating. Mine it (even via interview), score it with the 5-factor model, propose the stack, and sketch a 90-day pilot — all on one page.

DELIVERABLES

- Process scored with all five factors and a one-line justification each
- Stack proposal: which is RPA, which AI, which mining-only
- Year-1 net ROI calculation with cited numbers (volume × time × ₹ saved)
- 90-day pilot plan with three measurable milestones
- Top three risks named, each with a one-sentence mitigation

WHAT 'GOOD' LOOKS LIKE

A great submission could be presented to a CFO tomorrow morning. Numbers cited. Stack defensible. Risks honest. Pilot achievable.

SUMMARY

Five sentences to remember

If you remember nothing else from this lesson, remember these five lines.

- 1 RPA clicks. AI thinks. Mining sees. The three together rewrite how work happens.
- 2 Mine first. Automate next. Add intelligence last. Reverse this and the programme stalls.
- 3 Six criteria spot a real candidate: volume, rules, digital, stable, error-cost, time.
- 4 The 5-factor ROI model is the math that wins funding — not the storytelling.
- 5 The right tool fits your stack and your local talent — not the analyst's quadrant.

END OF LESSON 6

What you can now do

Each one of these is now part of your working vocabulary.

- 1 Define RPA, AI and process mining without confusing the three.
- 2 Pick the right stack order for any new automation programme.
- 3 Score automation candidates against six clear criteria.
- 4 Run any candidate through the 5-factor ROI model in five minutes.
- 5 Sketch a 90-day pilot pitch that survives a CFO conversation.

NEXT → LESSON 7 — Process Discovery & Opportunity Analysis